



FLAG OF SOLIDARNOSC

Anti-communist feeling in Central and Eastern Europe in the 1980s led, in Poland, to the creation of the independent labor union Solidarność (Solidarity), to which Witold Lutosławski lent his support. Solidarność's flag, with its iconic red lettering, is shown here.

A temporary freedom

With Stalin's death in 1953, official attitudes became more relaxed, and Lutosławski felt he had the freedom to explore the new musical idioms that were being developed in the West. He experimented with such techniques as serial composition, atonal harmony, and even aleatoric (chance) elements, but incorporated them into his own, more traditional musical language, rather than attempting to emulate or adopt them completely.

His reputation as a highly original composer spread worldwide during the 1960s, but this became overshadowed once again by political unrest in Poland through the 1970s and 1980s. Although